

MADE BETTER LC · META ADVERTISING

The rules an ad has to pass.

This is a reference, not a template. There are no ad layouts in here on purpose. Design the ad however the offer needs it, then check it against this page before it goes live.

Where these run

Facebook and Instagram feed, Stories, Reels

Source of truth

The website's own design system

Covers

Colour, type, text treatment, logo

Bark, brick, gold, leaf.

Every colour here is sampled from the logo mark and nothing else: the two brick colours and the two leaf greens. The same palette runs on the website, so an ad and the landing page it points at look like the same company. Gold is the one that gets people into trouble, so read the second half of this section before you set any gold text.

#160E07

Bark

The dark surface. The logo brown taken almost to black, never pure black. Backgrounds, scrims, text on light.

#6B4526

Brick

The logo brown itself. A second surface when a whole ad in bark is too heavy, and a fill behind white text.

#C38D33

Gold

The gold brick. The accent. A fill first and a text colour second. Buttons, rules, dots, and text on dark only.

#8EBE41

Leaf

The light leaf. A fill, and text on bark only. It is far too pale to be text on a light surface.

#F7F4EE

Warm wash

The light surface. Never plain white for a full background: it goes blue next to the greens.

Working variants

#241809

Bark raised

A panel sitting on bark. Cards, quote blocks, price chips.

#2E6F11

Leaf deep

The dark leaf. The only green that may be text on a light surface.

#856022

Gold on light

The only gold allowed as text on a light background at any size.

#A67A2B

Gold display

Gold on light for large text only. See the matrix.

#EAD6AC

Gold soft

Gold-family text on bark when full gold is too loud.

The gold trap

Gold #C38D33 on white measures **2.93:1**. That is well under the 4.5:1 a person needs to read a caption, and under the 3:1 that even a big headline needs. It looks fine on a desktop monitor in a bright room and disappears on a phone outdoors, which is exactly where these ads get seen.

So: **gold is a fill**. Put gold behind bark text, not the other way round. If you genuinely need gold-coloured words on a light background, use #856022, or #A67A2B at display size only.

And the same trap in green

The light leaf #8EBE41 on warm wash is **1.99:1**, worse than gold. It is a fill and nothing else on a light surface. When you want green words on light, they are leaf deep #2E6F11. On bark, the light leaf is fine at any size.

Contrast matrix

Measured ratios. "Any size" clears 4.5:1. "Large only" clears 3:1, meaning 24px and up, or bold at 19px and up, which on a 1080px ad canvas is roughly anything above 40px. Anything marked Fail does not go on an ad.

TEXT	ON	SAMPLE	RATIO	VERDICT
White #FFFFFF	Bark	Free estimate	19.09	● ANY SIZE
Bark #160E07	Warm wash	Free estimate	17.39	● ANY SIZE
Gold soft #EAD6AC	Bark	Free estimate	13.38	● ANY SIZE
Leaf #8EBE41	Bark	Free estimate	8.72	● ANY SIZE
Bark #160E07	Leaf	Free estimate	8.72	● ANY SIZE
White #FFFFFF	Brick	Free estimate	8.39	● ANY SIZE
Brick #6B4526	Warm wash	Free estimate	7.64	● ANY SIZE
Gold #C38D33	Bark	Free estimate	6.53	● ANY SIZE
Bark #160E07	Gold	Free estimate	6.53	● ANY SIZE
White #FFFFFF	Leaf deep	Free estimate	6.18	● ANY SIZE
Leaf deep #2E6F11	Warm wash	Free estimate	5.63	● ANY SIZE
Gold on light #856022	Warm wash	Free estimate	5.18	● ANY SIZE
Gold display #A67A2B	Warm wash	Free estimate	3.52	● LARGE ONLY
Leaf deep #2E6F11	Bark	Free estimate	3.09	● LARGE ONLY
Gold #C38D33	White	Free estimate	2.93	● FAIL
White #FFFFFF	Gold	Free estimate	2.93	● FAIL
Gold #C38D33	Brick	Free estimate	2.87	● FAIL
Gold #C38D33	Warm wash	Free estimate	2.66	● FAIL
Leaf #8EBE41	Warm wash	Free estimate	1.99	● FAIL

TEXT	ON	SAMPLE	RATIO	VERDICT
Gold #C38D33	Leaf	Free estimate	1.34	● FAIL

How the colours split the work

- **Bark carries the ad.** Dark ads outperform light ones in a feed because the feed itself is white or near-black, and a mid-tone photo with a bark block reads as a designed thing rather than a post.
- **Gold is the one bright thing.** One gold element per ad. A gold button and a gold headline and a gold border is three, and none of them get looked at.
- **Leaf is a substitute, not an addition.** Reach for it when the photo is already full of gold light and the gold would vanish into it. On a light surface that means leaf deep #2E6F11, never the light leaf.
- **Brick is the middle setting.** When a full bark ad is too heavy for the photo, the same block in brick #6B4526 still holds white text at 8.4:1. It is the logo's own brown, so it never reads as a fifth colour.
- **Warm wash, never pure white.** A pure white panel next to these greens reads blue and cheap. #F7F4EE or #EFEAE0.
- **No colour that is not on this page.** Not a red urgency banner, not a yellow star, not a blue "verified" tick. Every colour above is in the logo. If an ad needs one that is not, it needs a different idea.

Two faces. Tight tracking. Nothing else.

Plus Jakarta Sans at 800 for anything big, Inter for everything small. The negative tracking on the headlines is what stops a large sans from reading as a phone's default font, so do not skip it.

DISPLAY FACE

Plus Jakarta Sans

Weight 800 for headlines and the eyebrow.
Weight 700 for a subhead or a button label.
Tracking -0.02em . Line height 1.08 to 1.15
on an ad, tighter than the website, because
ad headlines are short.

TEXT FACE

Inter

Weight 400 to 600 for the support line, the
price, the fingerprint. Never 800: that is the
display face's job, and two heavy sans
faces in one frame look like a mistake.

The scale, as a share of canvas width

Every Meta size we run is **1080px wide**, so pegging type to the width gives one scale that works on the square, the portrait and the story without redoing the maths. The px column is the value at 1080.

EYEBROW 2.2% of width · 24px @1080 · Jakarta 700 · $+0.17\text{em}$ · uppercase

LAWN CARE · MICHIGAN

HEADLINE 7.5% of width · 81px @1080 · Jakarta 800 · -0.02em · LH 1.08

Your yard, done right.

Range: 6.5% to 9% of width. Go to 9% only for a three or four word headline.

SUBHEAD 3.7% of width · 40px @1080 · Jakarta 700 · -0.015em · LH 1.25

Free estimate, no pressure

SUPPORT LINE 2.8% of width · 30px @1080 · Inter 500 · LH 1.45

Owner on site. Itemised pricing. Same week.

BUTTON LABEL 3.0% of width · 32px @1080 · Jakarta 700 · 10px radius

Get a free estimate

Bark on gold, never white on gold. Corner radius 10px, matching the site's buttons.

FINEPRINT 1.9% of width · 21px @1080 · Inter 400 · the floor

Offer good through the end of the month.

Nothing goes below 1.9% of width. At 1080 that is 21px, which is about 6px on a phone. Below it, nobody reads it and it just makes the ad look busy.

Type rules

- **Two sizes per ad, three at the very most.** A headline, a support line, a button. Every extra size costs you a beat of attention.
-
- **Never stretch, condense, or outline the type.** If it does not fit, cut a word.
-
- **No drop shadows on text.** Contrast comes from the surface behind it. See the next section.
-
- **Sentence case for headlines.** ALL CAPS is reserved for the eyebrow, where the letter-spacing is doing the work.
-
- **No italics.** The brand does not have an italic voice, and the display face's italic reads as a different family.

Where the words go, and how few of them.

An ad gets somewhere between half a second and a second and a half. Everything in this section is about making the one idea survive that.

The three canvases and their dead zones

Hatched red is covered by the platform's own interface. Nothing readable goes there. The dashed box is where the message lives.



Square

1080 × 1080 • 1:1

Feed. No platform furniture over the image. Keep an 8% margin so nothing touches an edge.

Portrait

1080 × 1350 • 4:5

The best feed size: it takes the most screen. But the profile grid crops it to the centre square, so the headline and logo stay inside the gold band.

Story / Reel

1080 × 1920 • 9:16

The bottom third is eaten by the caption, the audio ticker and the CTA. Design to the Reels number and the ad is safe in Stories too.

The safe zones are not a suggestion

On a Reel, Meta reserves roughly the **top 250px** and the **bottom 640px** of a 1080 × 1920 frame for its own interface. A headline placed low in the frame is not "at the bottom of the ad", it is behind the caption and the profile name. Stories are less greedy, about 250px top and 340px bottom, so a creative built to the Reels safe zone runs in both without a second export.

How much text

7

Words, headline max

Over two lines at the most. Around 22 characters per line.

12

Words, support line max

One line. If it wraps to three, it is a paragraph and it will not be read.

25

Words on the whole canvas

Everything visible added together, button and fineprint included.

1

Idea per ad

One offer, one proof point, one action. Two offers is zero offers.

The long version of the pitch belongs in the primary text field above the image, where there is room for it and where nobody has to read it to understand the picture.

Placing the text block

- **Pick a third and commit to it.** Top third or bottom third. Text floating in the middle of a photo has nothing holding it and reads as a stock template.
- **On 9:16, the upper-middle.** It is the only region both Stories and Reels leave alone.
- **Left-align everything.** Centred type on a photo is the single most reliable tell of an amateur ad. The only exception is a single word.
- **Text and photo subject do not overlap.** If the words sit over the lawn, they are competing with the thing you are selling.
- **The button goes last in reading order.** Bottom of the text block, not the top, not floating off on its own.

Text over a photo: the scrim rule

White text needs the pixels underneath it at or below roughly **18% luminance** to stay readable. A photo of a sunlit lawn is nowhere near that. So the photo gets darkened

where the text sits, every time, with no exceptions and no shadows used as a substitute.



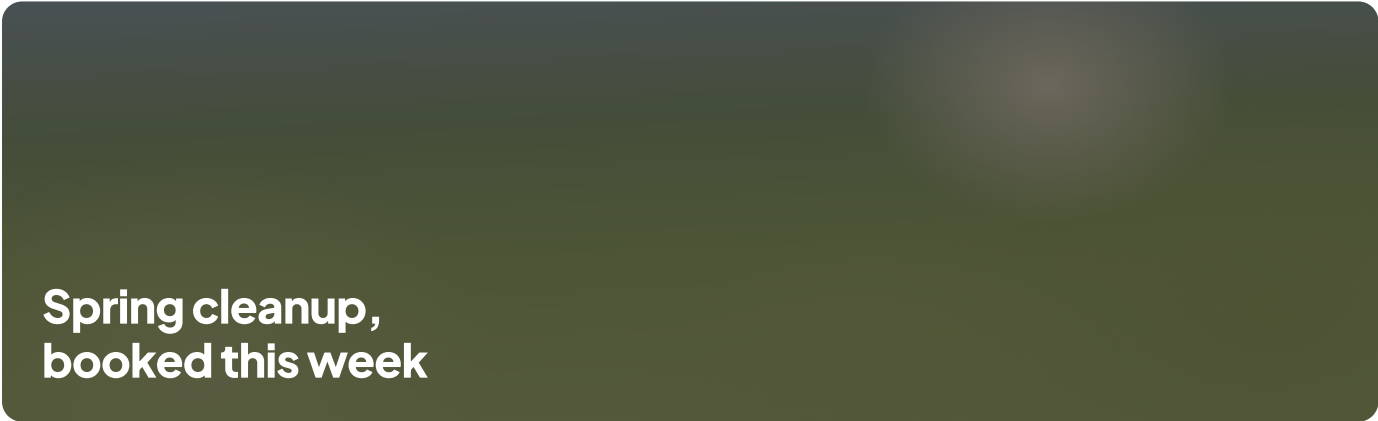
Spring cleanup,
booked this week

✗ **No scrim.** Legible on a monitor, gone on a phone in daylight. This is what most local ads look like.



Spring cleanup,
booked this week

✓ **Gradient scrim.** Bark at 90% fading to nothing by 62% up the frame. The default: it keeps most of the photo.



Spring cleanup,
booked this week

✓ **Flat scrim.** Bark at 62% across the whole image. For when text sits high, or the photo is busy everywhere.

Scrim recipes

- **Gradient:** bark #160E07 at 90% opacity at the text edge, falling to 0% by 60% across the frame. Text sits in the 90% end.
-
- **Flat:** bark at 55% minimum, 62% if the photo has bright sky or concrete in it.
-
- **Solid block:** a bark panel with the text inside it, photo untouched. The cleanest option and the one that survives any photo.

- **Gold text never goes over a photo.** Not with a scrim, not with a shadow. Gold over a photo is 2 point something to one against the bright bits, whatever you do to it. Gold on an ad means a solid bark or gold surface. The light leaf behaves the same way and is worse.
-
- **A drop shadow is not a scrim.** It fakes contrast at the letter's edge and fails on the letter's interior. Every phone screenshot of a shadowed headline looks muddy.
-
- **No blur behind text.** It looks like the photo is out of focus, which for a landscaping company is the wrong signal entirely.

Small, quiet, and in the same corner every time.

The logo is not the ad. It is the signature. Its job is to be there when someone who already saw the last ad scrolls past this one.

The mark



Served from the same Google Drive file the website uses. If it does not render above, the file is not publicly readable and needs a proper asset dropped into this folder.

The wordmark

MADE BETTER.

Plus Jakarta Sans 800, tracking $-0.02em$, all caps, with the full stop in gold. The full stop is the whole idea: it is the "better" being a finished thing. Never drop it, never colour it the same as the words.

Sizing and clear space

Clear space

dashed line = nothing crosses it



The gap between the mark and the dashed line is the clear space. Measure it as half the mark's own height, so it scales with the logo. Nothing crosses the dashed line: no headline, no photo subject, no canvas edge.

Minimum size on a 1080 canvas

- **Logo mark: 90px tall.** Roughly 8% of the canvas width. Below that the detail turns to mush at feed scale.
- **Wordmark: 28px tall.** The fallback when the frame is too tight for the mark.
- **Maximum: 140px.** A logo bigger than the headline is a business-card, not an ad.
- **One placement per campaign.** Bottom-left or top-left, chosen once, kept across every ad in the set.

Backgrounds

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- ✓ On warm wash. The gold full stop uses #856022 on light.

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- ✓ On bark. Full gold #C38D33 for the stop. The strongest of the four.

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- ✓ Over a photo, but only inside a solid bark chip. Never straight onto the image.

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- ✗ Never on gold. The stop has nothing to contrast against, so the idea dies.

- **Never recolour the mark** to match a photo, a season, or a holiday.
-
- **Never add a stroke, glow, bevel or shadow** to make it show up. If it needs help showing up, it needs a chip behind it.
-
- **Never rotate or place it at an angle.**
-
- **Never put the logo and the wordmark in the same corner.** Pick one per ad.
-
- **Never let the logo be the largest element.** The offer is.

05 PRE-FLIGHT

Run this before anything goes live.

Nine checks. If one fails, the ad does not ship, it gets fixed.

01 Every colour on the canvas is on this page.

Five colours off the logo mark and their listed variants. Nothing borrowed from a stock template.

02 No gold or light-leaf text on a light background, and neither over a photo.

If gold words are on light, they are #856022, or #A67A2B above 40px. Green words on light are #2E6F11.

03 All text sits inside the safe zone for its canvas.

9:16 in particular: nothing readable in the top 250px or the bottom 640px.

04 On 4:5, the headline and logo are inside the centre square.

The profile grid crops to 1:1 and will cut anything at the top or bottom edge.

05 Text over a photo has a real scrim, not a drop shadow.

Bark at 55% flat, or a 90% to 0% gradient.

06 Under 25 words on the whole canvas, one idea, one action.

Headline at seven words or fewer, over two lines at most.

07 Nothing smaller than 21px at 1080 wide.

Fineprint included. If it will not fit above the floor, delete it.

08 The logo has its clear space and is not the biggest thing in the frame.

90px minimum, 140px maximum, same corner as the rest of the set.

09 Viewed at thumbnail size on an actual phone, the offer still reads.

Shrink it to 25% on screen. If the headline goes, the ad goes.

Made Better LC · Ads design kit. Colour, type and radius are taken from the website's own design system at `command-center/app/public/sites/made-better/site.js`. If the site's tokens change, change this page in the same pass.

Contrast ratios on this page were computed against the stated backgrounds, not estimated.